ERIKA L. VALLEJO

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

The College of Wooster
Assistant Professor, Political Science — August 2025–Present

EDUCATION

Michigan State University
Ph.D., Political Science — 2025
Fields: American Politics, Public Policy
Specializations: Chicano/Latino Studies & Women's and Gender Studies
Dissertation: *Intersectional Approaches to Understanding Working-Class Candidates and Politicians*
Committee: Eric Gonzalez Juenke (Chair), Nazita Lajevardi, Sarah Reckhow, Ian Ostrander, and Nicholas Carnes
M.A., Political Science — 2021

University of Texas Rio Grande Valley
B.A., Political Science and Philosophy — 2016

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Flores, Amanda, Angélica Ruvalcaba, Dianey Leal, and **Erika Vallejo**[1]. February 2025. "Midwest Tejanas: Navigating entre mundos juntas." In ¡Somos Tejanas! Chicana Identity and Culture in Texas, edited by Jodi Marin and Norma Cantú. Austin, TX: *University of Texas Press.*

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Bartlett, Catalina, Everardo Cuevas, Wilfredo Flores, **Erika Vallejo**, and Néstor Espinoza. "Pra(x)ical Lessons: Takeaways From Teaching A Chicanx Rhetorics Graduate Seminar." *Revise and Resubmit at Latinx Writing and Rhetoric Studies.*

Vallejo, Erika. "Generational Divides in Plain Sight." Chapter proposal accepted for *The American Research Handbook on Diversity, Equity & Inclusion*, section: "The Latinx and Hispanic Experience: Diaspora, Language, and Civic Engagement."

SELECTED WORKING PAPERS

Vallejo, Erika. 2024. "Barriers and Belonging: Working-Class Plus Political Candidacies in the U.S." *Dissertation Chapter.*

Vallejo, Erika. 2024. "How Do Voters Evaluate Working-Class Plus Candidates?" *Dissertation Chapter.*

Dickinson, Kesicia, Jamil Scott, **Erika Vallejo**, and Kennia L. Coronado. 2023. "Urban Progress? Understanding the Impact of Black and Brown Leadership in Cities Today." *Book Project.*

Vallejo, Erika. 2023. "Working-Class Plus State-Level Legislative Campaigns: Are They Successful?" *Dissertation Chapter.*

[1]Shared authorship.

PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

Vallejo, Erika. 2025. "White Balloon Up High." *Latino Book Review Magazine*.

Vallejo, Erika. December 2024. "Gilberto y Orfelinda." In *Somos Xicanas* Anthology, *Riot of Roses Publishing House*.

Vallejo, Erika. Fall 2024. "Examining Working-Class State-Level Candidates & Elections." *MSU AGEP Science Today Bulletin*.

Vallejo, Erika. Fall 2023. "Book Review: Crimes of the Tongue: Essays and Stories." *NEXO: Official Newsletter of the Julian Samora Research Institute*.

Vallejo, Erika. Fall 2021. "A Conversation with Dr. Jamil Scott." *MSU AGEP Science Today Bulletin*.

Vallejo, Erika. 2021. "The 'Diploma Divide': Does It Exist for Racial and Ethnic Minorities?" *Michigan Policy Wonk Blog*.

Juenke, Eric Gonzalez, Paru Shah, Bernard L. Fraga, and **Erika Vallejo**. October 23, 2020. "State Legislatures Likely to Have More Women and People of Color Next Year." *The Monkey Cage*, *The Washington Post*.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Contributor, Candidate Characteristics Cooperative (C3).	2019–2024
Contributor, Cooperative Election Study (CES).	2022, 2023
Research Assistant, "2022 State Legislative Primary Candidate Dataset."	2022
Research Assistant, APSA Presidential Task Force on Systemic Inequalities in the Discipline.	2021
Research Fellow, Institute for Public Policy and Social Research.	2020–2021
Contributor, 2020 Collaborative Multiracial Post-Election Survey (CMPS).	2020

TEACHING & MENTORSHIP EXPERIENCE

The College of Wooster

Introduction to U.S. National Politics

Women, Power and Politics

Race and Ethnicity in American Politics

Latinx Politics

Campaigns and Elections (Research Methods-Embedded)

Senior Independent Study Advisor

Michigan State University

Course Instructor, Gender and Politics	2024
Teaching Assistant/Lab Instructor, Introduction to Methods of Political Analysis	2023
Facilitator/Mentor, Summer Research Opportunities Program (SROP)	2022

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

"From Design to Practice: Creating Research-Intensive Undergraduate Courses." 2026
Sage Webinar.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

"Working-Class Plus State-Level Legislative Campaigns: Are They Successful?"
Presented at the 83rd Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference.
Chicago, IL. April 23-26, 2026.

"How Do Voters Evaluate Working-Class Candidates?"
Presented at the PSOC-CREW Joint Workshop hosted at Michigan State University.
March 14, 2025.

"Working-Class State-Level Legislative Campaigns: Are They Successful?"
Presented at Alliances for Graduate Education and the Professoriate (AGEP),
Chalk Talk. Both in-person and virtual. December 7, 2023.

"Working-Class State-Level Legislative Campaigns: Does Class-Based Rhetoric Work?"
Presented at Alumni Conference at Michigan State University. April 28, 2022.

"Working-Class State-Level Legislative Campaigns: Does Class-Based Rhetoric Work?"
Presented at the 79th Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference.
Chicago, IL. April 7-10, 2022.

"Examining Working-Class State-Level Candidates & Elections."
Presented at Alliances for Graduate Education and the Professoriate (AGEP),
Chalk Talk. Both in-person and virtual. March 17, 2022.

"Working-Class Campaigns: Does Class-Based Rhetoric Work?"
Presented at the PSOC-CREW Joint Workshop hosted online by Michigan State University.
December 3, 2021.

"Examining Working-Class State-Level Campaigns."
Presented at the Politics of Race, Immigration, and Ethnicity Consortium (PRIEC)
hosted by University of North Texas. Virtual Panel. November 19, 2021.

INVITED TALKS AND WORKSHOPS

"Midwest Tejanas: Navigating entre Mundos Juntas." 2026
The College of Wooster, *Women's History Month.* Invited Guest Speaker.

"Understanding Today's Immigration Crisis." 2026
The College of Wooster, *MLK Celebration: Love in Action.* Justice Dialogue. Co-Presenter.

"Xicana Voices: A Valuable Part of the American Literary Landscape." 2025
Wisconsin Book Festival Virtual Event. Invited Presenter.

"Midwest Tejanas: Navigating entre Mundos Juntas." 2025
Michigan State Federal Credit Union, *Affinity Group.* Invited Co-Presenter.

Social Justice Film & Discussion: "Fannie Lou Hamer's America." 2025
MSU, Libraries and WKAR Public Media, *MLK Celebration.* Invited Facilitator.

"Working-Class State Legislative Campaigns: Are They Successful?" 2023
Bowling Green State Uni., *Englehart Research Forum.* Invited Guest Speaker.

"Surviving Comp. Exams Workshop Series, Reading and Writing for Comps." 2023
MSU, *Womxn of Color Initiatives (WOCI).* Invited Speaker.

"Undergraduate Research Troubleshooting Panel." 2020
MSU, *Undergraduate Research Office.* Invited Panelist.

"Undergraduate Orientation." 2020
UTRGV, *Vaquero Roundup.* Invited Speaker.

"Resources for Grad School." 2019
UTRGV, *The Political Science Association of Students (PSA).* Invited Speaker.

GRANTS, AWARDS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

External

APSA Minority Fellows Program. $2,000. Spring 2020
AP Virtual Fellow in Assessment for U.S. Government & Politics. $500. Fall 2026

The College of Wooster

Sophomore Research Assistant (SRA) Funding, 112 hours. Spring 2026
Faculty Research Allowance (FRA) Conference Support. 2026
Departmental Adams Endowment Conference Support. $400. 2026

Michigan State University

College of Social Science Dissertation Completion Fellowship. $7,500. 2024
Graduate Teaching Award. $500. 2024
Alliances for Graduate Education and the Professoriate Scholar Award. $2,000. 2023
Julian Samora Endowment Graduate Scholarship. $2,000. 2023-2024
Departmental Summer Fellowship Award. $5,000. 2023
Graduate School Office Research Support Fellowship. $1,920. 2023
Graduate School Office Support. $276. 2022
College of Social Science Support. $276. 2022
Graduate School Office Fellowship. $750. 2022
Minority Politics Award. $1,000. 2022
College of Social Science Early Start Research Grant. $3,000. 2022
Departmental Summer Fellowship Award. $5,000. 2022
Graduate School Conference Support. $500. 2022
College of Social Science Conference Support. $560. 2022
Alliances for Graduate Education and the Professoriate Scholar Award. $2,000. 2021
Departmental Summer Fellowship Award. $5,000. 2021
College of Social Science Early Start Research Grant. $2,500. 2021
Departmental Summer Fellowship Award. $5,000. 2021
Graduate School Research Support. $1,050. 2020
College of Social Science Early Start Research Grant. $2,500. 2020
Departmental Summer Fellowship Award. $5,000. 2020
Departmental IQMR Program Support. $310. 2020
Pre-Dissertation Graduate School Fellowship. $1,490. 2020
Pre-Dissertation Graduate School Fellowship. $3,300. 2020
Minority Politics Conference Travel Award. $500. 2019
College of Social Science Early Start Research Grant. $6,000. 2019

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Departmental Service

The College of Wooster

Coordinated MPSA student travel; prepared the budget and Student Conference Travel Fund (SCTF) proposal	2025-2026

Michigan State University

President, Graduate Student Association	2022-2023
Professionalization Representative, Graduate Student Association	2020-2022
Graduate Student Union, Union Steward	2019-2021
First-Year Representative, Graduate Student Association	2019-2020

University Service

The College of Wooster

Classroom Stewards Committee Appointment	Present

Michigan State University

Council Member, Dean's Graduate Student Advisory Council	2022-2024
Editor, Alliances for Graduate Education and the Professoriate (AGEP), Science Today Bulletin	2021
Volunteer Judge and Facilitator, AGEP Fall Conference	2021
Panel Volunteer, AGEP and Eastern Michigan University Trio Programs	2019
Volunteer Judge, Mid-Michigan Symposium for Undergraduate Research Experiences (Mid-SURE)	2019

Discipline Service

Discussant, MPSA Conference. "Union Power and Political Participation" panel	2026
Discussant, MPSA Conference. "Undergraduate Research" standing E-panel	2022
Graduate Working Group Member, Citations and Inequities, APSA Presidential Task Force, "Examining Issues and Mechanisms of Systemic Inequality in the Discipline."	2020-2021

CERTIFICATIONS AND METHODS TRAINING

Graduate Certificate, Women's and Gender Studies (MSU)	2023
Summer Institute in Survey Research Techniques (UM), Qualitative Methods: Overview & Semi-Structured Interviewing	2022
Graduate Certificate, Chicano/Latino Studies (MSU)	2022
Institute for Qualitative & Multi-Method Research (IQMR)	2021
Process Tracing in Qualitative & Mixed Methods Research (ICPSR)	2020
Introduction to Mixed Methods Research (ICPSR)	2020
EITM Certification for Race, Ethnicity, & Quantitative Methodology II	2020
Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR)	2018, 2020

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

American Political Science Association (APSA)
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)
The Consortium on the American Political Economy (CAPE)
Research on the Economic Characteristics of Officeholders News (RECON)

SKILLS

Statistical/Computer: R, LaTeX, NVivo
Languages: Spanish (Intermediate)